Their fans include not just the moviegoer in the north but also their counterparts in the Hindi film industry. Alia Bhatt and Ranbir Kapoor are Allu Arjun fans, R. Madhavan is one too. "Allu Arjun is a good-looking guy but decided to be scruffy and still managed to make Pushpa charming," says the actor. "Look at the life and energy Jr NTR and Ram Charan gave *RRR*." It didn't come easy, the actors spent a lot of time on the projects. Allu Arjun, for instance, spent four months in 2020 learning and acing the Chittoor Telugu accent over video calls. The swagger came courtesy director Sukumar. "Sukumar *garu* said, 'I don't know what you do, but everybody has to walk like you'," recalls Allu Arjun, who came up with the sloping shoulder, convinced that it would be "easily imitable". Yash has devoted six years to the KGF

"I always wanted to tell larger-than-life stories. I don't think of economics when I am developing my movies"

—**S.S. RAJAMOULI**
Director, Bahubali films

